

Computer Networking

Definition

Computer networking is the process of **connecting two or more computers** to **share data, resources, and services** (like files, printers, or internet).

Main Purpose

- Communication
- Resource sharing
- Data sharing
- Remote access

Types of Networks

1. **LAN (Local Area Network)**: Small area (home, school).
2. **MAN (Metropolitan Area Network)**: Covers a city.
3. **WAN (Wide Area Network)**: Covers large areas (like the Internet).

Network Devices

- **Router**: Connects different networks.
- **Switch**: Connects devices in a LAN.
- **Hub**: Sends data to all devices.
- **Modem**: Connects to the internet.

Examples

- School computer lab network
- Internet
- Office network

IPv4 Address

Definition

IPv4 (Internet Protocol version 4) is the **4th version** of the Internet Protocol used to **identify devices on a network** using a **unique 32-bit address**.

Format

- Written as **four numbers** separated by dots (e.g., **192.168.1.1**)
- Each number = **8 bits (1 byte)**
- Total = **32 bits = 4 bytes**

Address Range

0.0.0.0 → 255.255.255.255

Types of IPv4 Addresses

- 1. **Public IP:** Used on the internet.
- 2. **Private IP:** Used inside local networks.
- 3. **Static IP:** Fixed address.
- 4. **Dynamic IP:** Changes automatically.

Classes of IPv4

Class	Range	Use
A	1.0.0.0 – 126.255.255.255	Large networks
B	128.0.0.0 – 191.255.255.255	Medium networks
C	192.0.0.0 – 223.255.255.255	Small networks
D	224.0.0.0 – 239.255.255.255	Multicasting
E	240.0.0.0 – 255.255.255.255	Experimental

Example

192.168.0.1 → Private IP (Class C)

Subnet Mask

Definition

A **subnet mask** is a **32-bit number** that divides an IP address into two parts:

- **Network part** – identifies the network.
- **Host part** – identifies the specific device in that network.

Example

IP Address:

192.168.1.10

Subnet Mask:

255.255.255.0

Binary:

11111111.11111111.11111111.00000000

- ☒ The first 24 bits (1s) → Network
- ☒ The last 8 bits (0s) → Host

Purpose

- To separate **networks** and **hosts**
- To use IP addresses efficiently
- To improve **network management** and **security**

Common Subnet Masks

CIDR	Subnet Mask	No. of Hosts
/8	255.0.0.0	16,777,214
/16	255.255.0.0	65,534
/24	255.255.255.0	254

Formula to Find Hosts

$$\text{Hosts} = 2^{(32 - \text{Network bits})} - 2$$

Example:

For /24 $\rightarrow 2^{(32 - 24)} - 2 = 254$ hosts

Domain Name System (DNS)

Definition

DNS (Domain Name System) is a **naming system** that **converts domain names** (like www.google.com) into **IP addresses** that computers use to identify each other on the internet.

Purpose

- Makes it easier to access websites without remembering IPs.
- Acts like the “**phonebook**” of the internet.

How It Works

1. User types a website name.
2. DNS server translates the name into an IP address.
3. Browser connects to that IP to load the website.

Important Terms

- **Domain Name:** Human-readable name (e.g., google.com)
- **DNS Server:** Translates domain to IP
- **IP Address:** Numerical address of a website
- **Resolver:** Finds the IP address requested by the user

Hierarchy of DNS

1. **Root Domain (.)**
2. **Top-Level Domain (TLD):** `.com`, `.org`, `.in`
3. **Second-Level Domain:** `google` in `google.com`
4. **Subdomain:** `mail.google.com`

💡 Example

`www.yahoo.com` → DNS → `98.137.11.163`

🔄 How DNS Servers Work

📖 Definition

DNS servers are systems that **translate domain names into IP addresses** so browsers can locate and connect to websites.

⚙️ Working Steps (Process)

1. **User Request:**
You type `www.google.com` in the browser.
2. **DNS Resolver:**
The request goes to a **DNS resolver** (usually your ISP's server).
3. **Root Server:**
Resolver asks the **Root DNS Server** where to find the Top-Level Domain (TLD) server (`.com`).
4. **TLD Server:**
TLD server gives the address of the **Authoritative DNS Server** for `google.com`.
5. **Authoritative Server:**
It provides the **actual IP address** of `www.google.com`.
6. **Browser Connects:**
The resolver sends that IP back to your browser, which connects to the website.

💡 Example

`www.google.com` → DNS Resolver → Root Server → TLD Server → Authoritative Server → IP Address → Website loads

🔄 Key Servers in DNS Process

- **Resolver:** Finds IP on behalf of the user.
 - **Root Server:** Directs to correct TLD server.
 - **TLD Server:** Points to the domain's authoritative server.
 - **Authoritative Server:** Holds the final IP information.
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📦 Port Numbers

Definition

A **port number** is a **numerical identifier** that helps a computer **distinguish between different types of network services or processes** running on the same device.

Purpose

- Allows multiple network applications to use the same IP address.
- Identifies **specific services** (like web, email, FTP).

Range of Port Numbers

- **0 – 65535** (Total 65,536 ports)

Types of Ports

1. **Well-known Ports (0–1023):** Used by common services
 - HTTP → 80
 - HTTPS → 443
 - FTP → 21
 - SSH → 22
 - DNS → 53
2. **Registered Ports (1024–49151):** Used by user or custom apps
3. **Dynamic / Private Ports (49152–65535):** Temporary ports for client communication

Example

`https://www.example.com:443` → Port 443 used for HTTPS

Note

Each application on a device uses a **unique port number** to send and receive data.

Network Interfaces

Definition

A **network interface** is the **point of connection** between a computer and a network. It allows the device to **send and receive data** over that network.

Purpose

- Connects a device to LAN, WAN, or the internet.
- Handles communication between hardware and network software.

Types of Network Interfaces

1. **Wired Interface:** Uses cables (like Ethernet).

2. **Wireless Interface:** Uses Wi-Fi or Bluetooth.
3. **Virtual Interface:** Created by software (e.g., VPN, virtual machines).

Examples

- **Ethernet card (NIC)** – for wired connection
- **Wi-Fi adapter** – for wireless connection
- **Loopback interface (127.0.0.1)** – for internal testing

NIC (Network Interface Card)

- Hardware device that provides network connectivity.
- Has a unique **MAC address** (Media Access Control).

MAC Address

Definition

A **MAC address** (Media Access Control address) is a **unique hardware identifier** assigned to a device's **network interface card (NIC)** for communication within a network.

Format

- 48-bit (6 bytes) address.
 - Written in **hexadecimal**, divided by colons or hyphens.
- 👉 Example: **00:1A:2B:3C:4D:5E**

Purpose

- Identifies devices uniquely on a local network.
- Used in data link layer (Layer 2) of the OSI model.
- Helps in transferring data packets within the same network.

Types of MAC Address

1. **Unicast:** Identifies a single device.
2. **Multicast:** For a group of devices.
3. **Broadcast:** For all devices in a network.

Key Points

- Assigned by the device manufacturer.
- Cannot be changed (but can be spoofed).
- Works within **LAN**, not over the internet.

Firewalls

Definition

A **firewall** is a **security system** that **monitors and controls incoming and outgoing network traffic** based on **predefined security rules**.

Purpose

- Protects a computer or network from **unauthorized access**.
- Blocks **malicious traffic** and allows **safe communication**.

Types of Firewalls

1. **Packet Filtering Firewall**: Checks each data packet and allows or blocks it.
2. **Proxy Firewall**: Acts as a gateway between users and the internet.
3. **Stateful Inspection Firewall**: Monitors the state of active connections.
4. **Next-Generation Firewall (NGFW)**: Advanced; includes antivirus, intrusion prevention, etc.

Works On

- **Network Layer** and **Transport Layer** of the OSI model.

Functions

- Filters harmful data packets.
- Prevents hacking and malware attacks.
- Monitors all incoming/outgoing traffic.

Examples

- Windows Defender Firewall
- Cisco ASA

OSI Model

Definition

The **OSI (Open Systems Interconnection) model** is a **conceptual framework** that defines **how data travels** through a network in **7 layers**.

Purpose

- Helps understand and design network communication.
- Standardizes how devices communicate.

7 Layers of OSI Model (Top to Bottom)

1. **Application (Layer 7)**: User interface (e.g., HTTP, FTP).
2. **Presentation (Layer 6)**: Data translation, encryption, compression.

- 3. **Session (Layer 5):** Manages sessions and connections.
- 4. **Transport (Layer 4):** Ensures reliable data transfer (TCP/UDP).
- 5. **Network (Layer 3):** Handles IP addressing and routing.
- 6. **Data Link (Layer 2):** Error detection, MAC addressing.
- 7. **Physical (Layer 1):** Transmission of raw bits (cables, signals).

 Mnemonic

 All People Seem To Need Data Processing (Top to Bottom)

 TCP/IP Model

 Definition:

The **TCP/IP model (Transmission Control Protocol / Internet Protocol)** is a networking framework used to connect devices on the internet.
It defines how data is transmitted and received.

 Purpose:

- Basis of the modern Internet.
- Helps computers communicate over networks reliably.

 Layers of TCP/IP Model (4 Layers):

- 1. **Application Layer** – User interaction (HTTP, FTP, DNS, SMTP).
- 2. **Transport Layer** – Reliable delivery (TCP, UDP).
- 3. **Internet Layer** – Handles addressing and routing (IP).
- 4. **Network Access Layer** – Physical transmission (Ethernet, Wi-Fi).

 Mnemonic:

 **A Tiny Intelligent Network**
(Application → Transport → Internet → Network Access)

 Comparison with OSI Model:

TCP/IP Layer	OSI Layers
Application	Application, Presentation, Session
Transport	Transport
Internet	Network
Network Access	Data Link, Physical

 Example Protocols:

- **Application Layer:** HTTP, FTP, DNS
 - **Transport Layer:** TCP, UDP
 - **Internet Layer:** IP, ICMP
 - **Network Access Layer:** Ethernet, Wi-Fi
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✓ Network Topologies

▣ Definition:

Network topology refers to the layout or arrangement of devices (nodes) and how they are connected in a network.

💡 Types:

1. **Bus** – One main cable; cheap but hard to troubleshoot.
 2. **Star** – All connect to a hub; reliable.
 3. **Ring** – Circular connection; one failure affects all.
 4. **Mesh** – Every device connected to all; costly but strong.
 5. **Tree** – Hierarchical mix of star + bus.
 6. **Hybrid** – Combo of topologies; flexible & scalable.
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✓ TCP and UDP

▣ Definition:

TCP (Transmission Control Protocol) and **UDP (User Datagram Protocol)** are **Transport Layer protocols** used for data transmission over the Internet.

💡 TCP (Transmission Control Protocol):

- **Connection-oriented** – establishes a connection before data transfer.
- **Reliable** – ensures data is delivered in order.
- **Error checking & flow control** available.
- **Slower** but **accurate**.
- 3-way handshake (connection setup)
- Acknowledgments (ACKs)
- 📦 *Used in:* Web (HTTP/HTTPS), Email (SMTP), File transfer (FTP).

🔊 UDP (User Datagram Protocol):

- **Connectionless** – no setup before sending data.
- **Unreliable** – data may be lost or out of order.
- **No error checking or acknowledgment.**
- **Faster** but less reliable.
- 🎮 *Used in:* Video streaming, online games, voice calls (VoIP).

Key Difference:

Feature	TCP	UDP
Connection	Connection-oriented	Connectionless
Reliability	Reliable	Unreliable
Speed	Slower	Faster
Error Checking	Yes	No
Example	HTTP, FTP	DNS, YouTube, Games

Accessing Remote Terminal Using SSH

◇ What is SSH?

- **SSH (Secure Shell)** is a protocol used to securely connect to remote systems.
- It allows you to **access, control, and manage** another computer over the internet or a network.

◇ How it Works

1. Connect using:

```
ssh username@remote_ip
```

2. Authenticate using password or SSH key.
3. Gain remote terminal access to run commands.

◇ Benefits

-  Encrypted and secure
-  Remote management
-  Protects against data interception

Transferring Files Using SCP

◇ What is SCP?

- **SCP (Secure Copy Protocol)** securely copies files between **local and remote systems**.
- It uses SSH for secure data transfer.

◇ Basic Commands

- **Upload (local → remote):**

```
scp file.txt username@remote_ip:/path/to/destination
```

- **Download (remote → local):**

```
scp username@remote_ip:/path/to/file.txt /local/path
```

- **Copy folder (recursive):**

```
scp -r folder username@remote_ip:/path/to/destination
```

◇ Benefits

-  Secure with SSH encryption
-  Fast and easy for file transfers

SSH Public and Private Keys

◇ Key Pair Concept

- SSH uses **asymmetric encryption** with two keys:
 - **Public Key:** Shared with the server
 - **Private Key:** Kept secret on your local system

◇ Authentication Process

1. Generate key pair:

```
ssh-keygen
```

2. Copy public key to the server:

```
ssh-copy-id username@remote_ip
```

3. SSH verifies your **private key** to log in without a password.

◇ Advantages

-  No password needed for every login
-  More secure than password authentication

- 🔒 Protects against brute-force attacks

Summary

Concept	Purpose	Command Example
SSH	Remote terminal access	<code>ssh user@ip</code>
SCP	Secure file transfer	<code>scp file user@ip:/path</code>
SSH Keys	Passwordless secure login	<code>ssh-keygen</code> , <code>ssh-copy-id</code>